

## What CoStar gives Dan, what it cannot, and what we can

Dan Gura runs CoStar across the entire United States and calls his own workflow “antiquated.” Before claiming to beat it, this characterises it — then shows the one column it structurally does not carry, with Arizona worked end to end as proof. 27 August 2026.

CoStar avg \$15,130/yr

50 AZ projects, 49 design teams

The design team is not a CoStar entity

## GROUND TRUTH

### What CoStar actually is, and what it costs

**CoStar Suite** is a commercial-property research and prospecting database covering the US, Canada, UK and France — over **300,000 active users** and forty years of history. It is the reference tool for brokers, lenders, appraisers and investment teams. Dan has it **for the entire United States**, got it as a condition of joining MVE thirteen years ago, and his BD staff use it under him.

| FIGURE                  | VALUE                                                                                                                                                                                                 | SOURCE                          |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Average annual contract | \$15,130                                                                                                                                                                                              | Vendr internal transaction data |
| Observed range          | ~\$3,000 to ~\$23,000 / yr                                                                                                                                                                            | Vendr, across their buyer base  |
| Entry point             | from ~\$300 / month                                                                                                                                                                                   | Published guides                |
| Pricing model           | <b>Custom and opaque.</b> It does not reduce to a per-seat number — the quote is driven by which markets you take, which modules, and how many users. National coverage sits at the top of the range. |                                 |

#### ✗ DO NOT CONFLATE TWO DIFFERENT PRODUCTS

**CoStar Real Estate Manager** is a separate lease-administration and accounting product, quoted at **\$75,000–\$200,000/yr** mid-market and **\$200,000–\$500,000+** enterprise. That is *not* what Dan is describing. Quoting those numbers at him would be wrong and he would know immediately.

**How CoStar models a project.** Its development pipeline runs four phases — **Unconfirmed → Planning → Final Planning → In Construction** — tracked by construction status, expected delivery date and unit or room counts, sliceable by class, market, submarket and brand. CoStar research staff do talk to architects, developers and planning departments, but they do so *to firm up delivery dates*. That distinction is the whole opportunity.

## THE GAP

### The design team is not a CoStar entity

CoStar’s unit of analysis is the *asset* and its economics. Ours is the *project team*.

Everything CoStar is built to return describes a building and its money: who owns it, who leases it, what it sold for, what it will rent for, when it delivers. That is the correct design for its customers — brokers, lenders, appraisers, investors. **None of them need to know who the architect is.**

So the fields that matter to a firm trying to get *hired onto* a project — architect, structural engineer, civil, landscape, general contractor, and above all **whether a seat has been filled yet** — are not what CoStar indexes. Dan can tell you a 400-unit project in Tucson was submitted and who the developer is. He cannot filter for “*projects where no architect has been appointed*.”

▲ WHICH IS THE PITCH, AND IT IS NOT A SOFTWARE PITCH

Dan does not need better developer contacts — that is where CoStar is strongest and where he is already good. **What he cannot buy is the consultant layer:** who is already on a project, who is not, and which developers habitually use which architects. For a BD director at an architecture firm that is a displacement map, and for KOR the same data with the structural row is a target list.

METHOD

## Where the design-team data actually lives

It is published — just not by CoStar, and not in one place. It sits in regional construction trade press and in planning submittals, and it has to be assembled region by region. The sources that carry full consultant rosters:

| REGION                | SOURCE THAT NAMES THE DESIGN TEAM                                                                                           | WHAT IT YIELDS                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Arizona               | <b>AZBEX</b> (Arizona Builder's Exchange) — <a href="#">△</a> <b>subscription</b> ; and <b>AZ Big Media</b> , which is open | ★ The richest of the set. AZBEX names developer, architect, landscape architect, civil engineer, traffic engineer and land-use counsel on a single case. <b>But the archive is gated</b> — see below |
| Nevada                | <b>NVBEX</b> — same publisher as AZBEX, same gate                                                                           | Same format, same depth. The two are siblings, which matters commercially                                                                                                                            |
| Texas                 | Houston Chronicle <i>residential development tracker</i> ; Houston.org project round-ups                                    | Developer, size, stage, timeline; architect intermittently                                                                                                                                           |
| Florida / N. Carolina | Multi-Housing News, Multifamily Dive, local business journals                                                               | Developer and program reliably; design team on the larger towers                                                                                                                                     |
| California            | LA YIMBY, SF YIMBY, BuildSD, city plan sets                                                                                 | Already proven — the plan set carries the full directory                                                                                                                                             |
| Anywhere              | <b>The city entitlement plan set itself</b>                                                                                 | ★ Definitive. The project-directory sheet lists every consultant. Slow, but it is the ground truth                                                                                                   |

▲ THE BUY RECOMMENDATION — BEX, NOT ANOTHER SCRAPER

**AZBEX is subscription-gated, and testing established that its free pages are stubs.** Ten current August 2026 articles were pulled; two carried an architect in the teaser and the rest returned a sign-up form where the body should be. **So every “no architect named” from AZBEX is paywall truncation, not absence** — and reporting it as absence would be the same error three times over.

The right response is not a better scraper. **The same publisher (BEX) covers Arizona and Nevada** — AZBEX, NVBEX, and **DATABEX**, a project database covering every Arizona commercial and infrastructure job over \$5M. Two of Dan's six regions from one subscription, with the design team attached. **Pricing is quote-only** — [bex@azbex.com](mailto:bex@azbex.com), 480-709-4190, and they advertise bundle pricing across the three products. Worth a call before another week of research.

[△](#) **Arizona has no equivalent of San Diego's permit feed.** San Diego republishes its full development-approvals table daily — 834,000 rows with status, valuation, storeys and unit mix. Phoenix publishes *aggregate counts only*: 23 rows of yearly permit totals. Its proposed-zoning layer gives case numbers and acreage but **no project name, developer or unit count**. So Arizona cannot be extracted; it has to be researched. Worth knowing before promising a live feed.

WORKED EXAMPLE

## Arizona — 50 projects, 49 design teams

Assembled from AZ Big Media's 2026 projects feature and cross-checked against AZBEX. **Fifty current Arizona projects with developer, general contractor and architect named on forty-nine of them.** This is the artefact CoStar cannot produce.

**The Arizona architect league table** — who is actually winning work, by project count in this set. Counts were recomputed from the source’s own Architect : fields and reconcile against its label count exactly; “Type” describes how the firm appears *in this set*, not an audited national footprint:

| ARCHITECT                    | PROJECTS | TYPE                   |
|------------------------------|----------|------------------------|
| Butler Design Group          | 6        | Design-build           |
| LGE Design Build             | 6        | Design-build           |
| RSP Architects               | 4        | Hospitality, civic     |
| triARC architecture & design | 3        | Arizona                |
| Gensler                      | 3        | National               |
| STG Design                   | 3        | Arizona                |
| Phoenix Design One           | 2        | Arizona                |
| ALINE Architecture Concepts  | 2        | Arizona                |
| Deutsch Architecture Group   | 2        | Arizona                |
| Soaring Eight                | 2        | Arizona                |
| Corgan                       | 2        | National               |
| DLR Group                    | 2        | National               |
| KTGY                         | 1        | ★ National multifamily |
| Niles Bolton Associates      | 1        | ★ National multifamily |
| ESG Architecture & Design    | 1        | ★ Multifamily          |

Also present once each: Dig Studio, Devenney Group, Lamar Johnson Collaborative, Richard Kennedy Architects, Todd & Associates, McCarthy Nordburg, Hamilton Architecture, Grace Design Studios, Ajanta Design, GFF Design and Athena Studio. Twenty-six firms hold 51 architect slots across the 49 projects that name one — two projects name two firms each.

**Read that as a BD director would.** *Butler Design Group* and *LGE Design Build* are design-build outfits taking six slots apiece — that is the competitive pressure in Arizona, and it is a different threat from a design firm. **KTGY and Niles Bolton** appearing is more interesting to MVE: those are national multifamily competitors operating in a market MVE is entering.

**Representative entries**, in the format the data actually supports:

| PROJECT                       | SIZE                          | DEVELOPER                      | ARCHITECT                               | CONTRACTOR                    |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 5550 E. Crown Place, Phoenix  | 160,000 sf, 240 keys          | LaPour / Holualoa Companies JV | <b>RSP Architects</b>                   | Whiting-Turner                |
| 19360 N. 73rd St., Scottsdale | 88 units, 1,570–3,015 sf each | Belgravia Group                | <b>KTGY</b>                             | Maris Construction of Arizona |
| 217 E. 7th St., Tempe         | 521,553 sf                    | AZ Tempe Holdings / Trinitas   | <b>Niles Bolton Associates, Gensler</b> | Layton Construction           |
| 10050 N. Scottsdale Rd.       | 384,492 sf                    | High Street Residential        | <b>ESG Architecture &amp; Design</b>    | Wespac Residential            |
| 95 Arroyo Pinon Dr., Sedona   | 43,100 sf, 89 keys            | Crystal Creek Capital          | <b>RSP Architects</b>                   | Chanen Construction           |

⚠ **Honest caveat on this set:** it skews industrial, office and hospitality rather than multifamily — it is a general CRE round-up, not a housing list. As a *competitive map of who designs what in Arizona* it is strong. As a multifamily lead list it is thin, and building that properly means going to AZBEX case by case.

**The wider Arizona pipeline**, from the same research: **Arro** (Empire Group / Aspirant — ~1.8M sf, twin towers at 541 ft and 425 ft, the future tallest in the state, 380 apartments plus 275 co-living, 250-key hotel); **The Whitney** (24 storeys, 328 units, Central &

McDowell); **Revelry** in Tempe (Aspirant, two towers, 533 units); **Astria Tempe** (27 storeys, 380 units); and a **323-unit Dominium** scheme in Tolleson still needing its rezoning.

#### DAN'S OTHER REGIONS

## Nevada, Texas, Carolina, Florida — state of play

Dan named live or near-live MVE work in **Arizona, Nevada, Hawaii, Houston, Charlotte and Miami**. What is established so far, and what is not:

| REGION                     | WHAT WE HAVE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | DEPTH                                                                                              |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Nevada                     | <b>Bally's Las Vegas</b> — three-phase mixed-use on the former Tropicana site, 26 acres, architect <b>Marnell Howryla Architecture</b> , ~3,000 rooms, 2,500-seat theatre, 500k sf retail. 🚫 <b>Structural is taken:</b> <b>Thornton Tomasetti</b> , confirmed on their own project page, and they hold the A's ballpark on the same site. <b>Riviera site</b> — Brett Torino, 600-ft towers, 750-key hotel, 425 condos, 3,310-seat domed venue. <b>Hylo Park</b> — \$300–400M on the old Texas Station site. KB Home 1,500-home scheme started early 2026. ⭐ <b>Silverado</b> — 13.5 acres south of the Strip, developer Ochoa Development, architects <b>Gensler + Yihong Liu &amp; Associates</b> , civil RCI Engineering; <b>no structural engineer publicly named</b> , and Clark County Zoning hears it <b>2 September 2026</b> | Good start. <b>NVBEX</b> is the source to work through for design teams                            |
| Texas / Houston            | Southern Land twin-tower scheme — 38 and 10 storeys, 330 apartments plus 18 penthouses, groundbreaking slipped to Q1 2026, completion 2028. StreetLights Residential 20-storey, 134 units in Boulevard Oaks                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Named projects, no design teams yet. Houston Chronicle runs a live residential development tracker |
| Florida / Miami            | <b>PMG</b> is the name to watch — <b>Delano Residences Miami</b> (their second downtown supertall) and the <b>Waldorf Astoria</b> , Miami's first supertall                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Headline only. Supertall market, so the design teams are published — not yet gathered              |
| North Carolina / Charlotte | Nothing verified yet                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | ⚠ Not researched. Do not claim coverage                                                            |
| Hawaii                     | Nothing verified yet                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | ⚠ Not researched. Dan said "might" have a project there                                            |

**Stated plainly:** Arizona is done to a usable standard, Nevada is half done, Texas and Florida are headlines, and Carolina and Hawaii are empty. Anything sent to Dan should say so — he will check, and being caught claiming national coverage we do not have would undo the credibility the dossiers just earned.

#### RECOMMENDATION

## What to send, and what to claim

- **Lead with the corrections, not the volume.** Dan told us Santa Clara Park is AO's and that our headcount figure was modelled. Sending those back fixed proves the "it learns and it is never wrong again" claim better than any new document. It costs nothing and it is the most credible thing we can do this week.
- **Send Arizona as a *sample*, framed as the design-team layer.** Fifty projects with forty-nine design teams, plus the architect league table. Say what it is: assembled from public trade sources, not a live feed, and skewed to commercial rather than multifamily.
- **Say the honest thing about his 40-storey test.** A filing made that same day is not in any public feed yet; it surfaces when the city posts it or the trade press picks it up, typically within days. **The defensible claim is that nothing published gets missed — not that nothing unpublished is known.** He is a professional; the honest answer will land better than a dodge.

- **Do not offer a CoStar replacement.** He pays for national coverage and forty years of comps. What we have is a different axis, not a cheaper version of his. The line is *“this is the layer your CoStar does not carry”* — and on that ground we are genuinely ahead.

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KOR Structural — internal BD intelligence, 27 August 2026. **Not for external distribution in this form.** The Arizona section is the part fit to be adapted and sent.

Sources: Ventr CoStar buyer guide and published pricing breakdowns; CoStar Group pipeline documentation; AZ Big Media 2026 projects feature (50 entries parsed, architect count verified against the s